

Budgets 1.0 - Feature Overview

What this feature is

Who Budgets is for (intended audience)

Scope (Budgets 1.0) and non-goals

Primary use cases supported

Adoption ladder (how value increases)

Key rules & limits

- Permissions

- Budget Pot limits

Money movement

- Cards & linking

- Visibility (important)

Account model & restrictions (ClearBank)

Pricing / plan notes (Team seats)

Entry points (where users can access Budgets)

How to create a Budget

- 1) From Cards page (during “Order” flow)

- 2) From Admin tabPath: Admin tab → Admin → Product → “Budgets” icon

- 3) From Accounts carousel

- 4) From “All accounts”

Where created Budgets are visible

Budget setup fields & controls

- Required

- Optional limits

Viewing Budgets & transactions (Admin experience)

- Budgets screen (overview)

- Switching between budgets quickly

- Budget detail page (transactions)

Editing a Budget

Deleting a Budget (closure behaviour)

Adding / withdrawing money

- Deposit (top up a budget)

- Withdraw

Cards on Budgets (virtual prepaid)

- Limits interaction: card vs budget

- Quick access to linked cards

Risk / Ops considerations (what to know)

Glossary

What this feature is

Budgets (also referred to as *Budget Pots*) let Admins set money aside from the main Business Current Account (BCA) into dedicated “pots”, and optionally issue *virtual cards* linked to those pots to control team spending. [Figma link.](#)

Budgets support:

- “Set money aside” use case (like a jar/pot).
- “Control expenses” use case via Budget limits + linking virtual cards (especially for team spend). E.g. a Budget can hold “X” amount but have daily/weekly or monthly limit which is different.

Who Budgets is for (intended audience)

Budgets can deliver value to most Tide Admins—solo operators and teams—who want to ring-fence funds for a specific purpose and, where needed, spend from that pot with clear guardrails.

At a high level, Budgets is best suited to Admins who:

- Use Tide as their primary day-to-day business account (frequent transactions and regular cash movement).
- Want to organise money by purpose (e.g., project- or category-based pots) without introducing a complex workflow.
- Are using (or open to using) virtual cards for dedicated spend streams, since that’s where Budgets becomes a spend-management tool rather than only “money set aside”.
- Want to organise Team Member expenses and apply strict control over them by issuing Team Expense Cards under a Budget e.g. “Team expenses”

Scope (Budgets 1.0) and non-goals

Budgets 1.0 provides manual money movement between the main BCA and up to 3 Budget Pots per company entity, plus the ability to link *virtual prepaid cards* to budgets and optionally apply budget-level spending limits.

Non-goals in 1.0:

- No external inbound/outbound bank transfers for the Budgets account (blocked).
- No automatic funding/sweeps/scheduled transfers; all budget funding/withdrawal is manual.
- No physical cards linked to budgets (virtual cards only).
- No team member visibility of budget balances/spend (Admin-only visibility).

Primary use cases supported

Use case 1 (Solo): Set money aside for a near-term purpose

An Admin creates a Budget to ring-fence funds for an upcoming expense (e.g., a marketing push, supplier payment, or short-term project cost), improving money organisation without needing additional accounts.

Use case 2 (Solo): Controlled spend from a dedicated pot via virtual card

An Admin links a virtual card to a Budget and uses it for the intended purpose, creating a simple loop: allocate → spend → review transactions for that Budget.

Use case 3 (Teams): Delegated spend with guardrails

An Admin allocates funds to a Budget and issues budget-linked virtual cards to team members, enabling delegated spend while keeping control through budget-level limits and card-level limits.

Adoption ladder (how value increases)

1. *Activation*: Create and fund a Budget (separate funds from main balance).
2. *Value realisation*: Link a virtual card and spend from the Budget (spend is naturally grouped by purpose).
3. *Expansion*: Extend to team spend by issuing budget-linked virtual cards to team members (delegated spend with controls).

Key rules & limits

Permissions

- Only *Admins* can create, edit, or delete a Budget Pot.
- Team Members can be issued virtual cards linked to budgets, but cannot manage budgets or see budget balances. In slice 1, Team Members are not informed if the issued virtual card is linked to a Budget or to a BCA. For them, it is just a virtual card.

Budget Pot limits

- Max number of Budget Pots: *3 per company entity*.

Money movement

- Money can only be moved *manually* between the main BCA and Budgets.
- Transfers are always *from/to the main BCA* (deposit to budget, withdraw back to main BCA).
- Deposits and withdrawals are “almost instant” in-app.

Cards & linking

- Only *virtual cards* can be linked to Budgets.
- Virtual cards linked to budgets are *Tide Prepaid* cards.
- Team Member virtual cards limit: up to *5 virtual cards* per team member (company-wide).
- Admin budget virtual cards limit: up to *5 virtual cards for Budgets only* (does not count towards other accounts/cards they may have).

- Existing cards can not be linked to Budgets
- Linked cards to Budgets can not be unlinked

Visibility (important)

- Admins can see budget balances and spend.
- Team Members with budget-linked cards *cannot* see the budget balance or how much has been spent through the budget.

Account model & restrictions (ClearBank)

A dedicated Budgets “account” is opened with ClearBank to hold nested sub-accounts (Budgets).

- The account number of the Budgets account is *not shared* with the Member.
- Outgoing *external transfers* are *blocked* for this account (not allowed).
- Incoming *external* transfers could be:
 - allocated to the first available budget, or
 - blocked and returned to the Sender (similar to TIS implementation)
- This account is *free for use* and *does not count* toward the member’s number of accounts.

Pricing / plan notes (Team seats)

Budgets themselves are free to use; the only costs may come from issuing Team Cards (seats).

- Smart plan: *1 seat free*
- Pro plan: *2 seats free*
- Max plan: *3 seats free*
- Outside the included allowance, it costs *£5 per seat / month*.

Entry points (where users can access Budgets)

Budgets are accessible from several places:

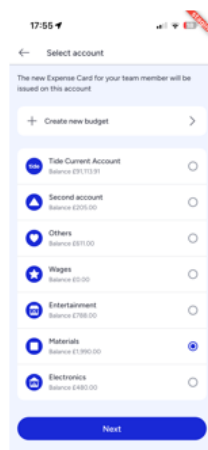
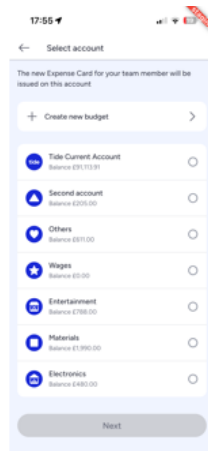
- Accounts
- Admin tab
- Order a Card flows (for both Team Member and Admin)

How to create a Budget

There are four creation entry points.

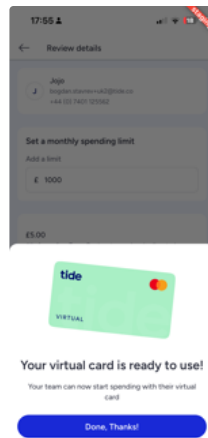
1) From Cards page (during “Order” flow)

1. User taps “+ Order” (Admin or Team Member).
2. User selects *Virtual card*.
3. During the journey, user is prompted to:
 - Link to an existing Budget Pot, or
 - Create a new Budget Pot.



1.1 Link to existing Budget

- If a Budget Pot already exists, user selects it.
- Once the card is issued, it becomes linked to that Budget.



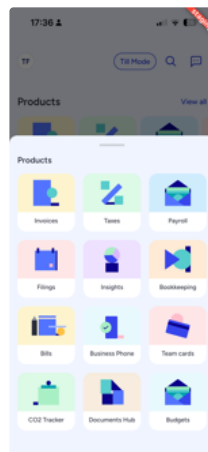
1.2 Create new Budget (then link)

- If “Create a new Budget” is selected, the Create Budget flow starts.
- At the end, the newly issued card is linked to the newly created Budget.

2) From Admin tab

Path: Admin tab → Admin → Product → “Budgets” icon

- If no budgets exist: opens the *Create a budget* flow.
- If at least 1 budget exists: opens the *Budgets screen* within Accounts.

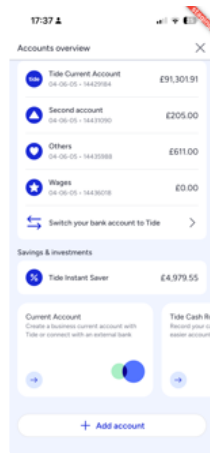


3) From Accounts carousel

Path: Accounts → scroll right to Budgets → “Create a budget” button

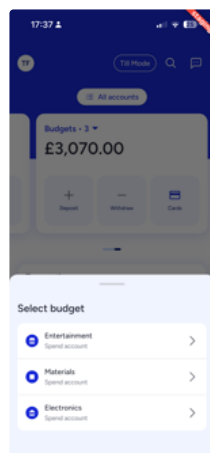
4) From “All accounts”

Path: Accounts → All accounts → + Add Account → “Budget Account”



Where created Budgets are visible

- Accounts: swipe/scroll right to the Budgets screen.
- Accounts: open “All accounts”.

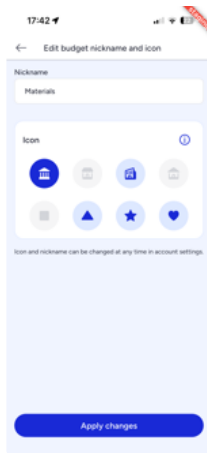


Budget setup fields & controls

Required

Each Budget must have:

- Nickname
- Icon



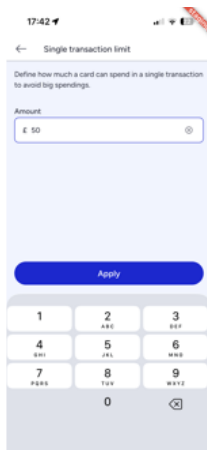
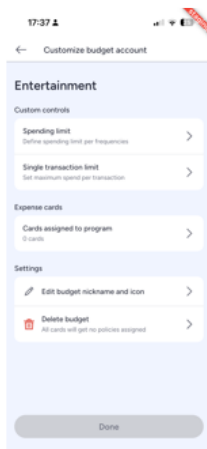
Optional limits

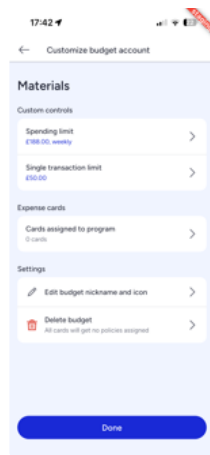
Limits can be set either:

- During creation, or
- Later via “Edit budget account” (from Budgets screen)

Available limit types:

- Spending limit: Amount + Frequency (daily / weekly / monthly)
- Single transaction limit: Amount only





Viewing Budgets & transactions (Admin experience)

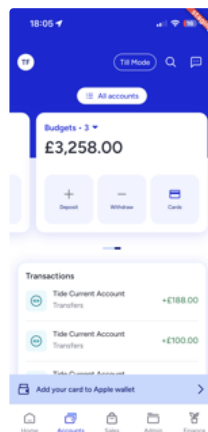
Budgets screen (overview)

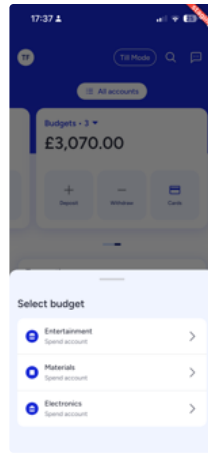
On the Budgets screen, Admins see:

- A list of all budgets
- Total amount for all budget
- Transactions related to budgets

An “Edit budget details” link is available:

- If more than 1 budget exists, selecting it opens a bottom sheet to pick which budget to edit. Same logic is used when selecting “+Deposit”, “+Withdraw”, “Cards”.

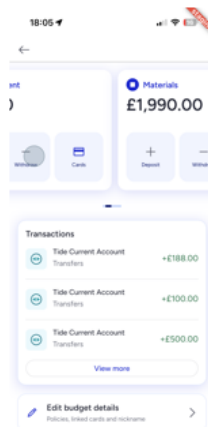




Switching between budgets quickly

If the user taps the “Arrow” button:

- A bottom sheet appears showing up to the 3 budgets.
- Selecting a budget opens a budget detail page.
- User can swipe right/left between budgets for quick review.



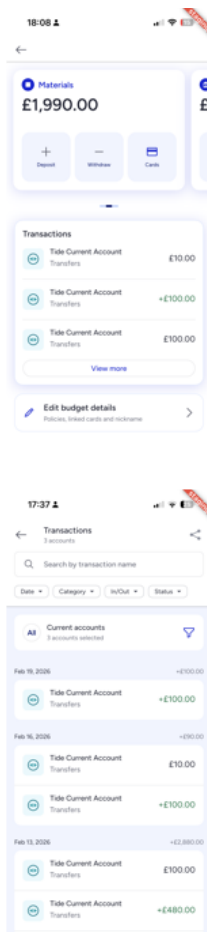
Budget detail page (transactions)

Each budget page shows “Transactions” including:

- Incoming transfers from main BCA
- Outgoing transfers (withdrawals back to main BCA)
- Card transactions on cards linked to that budget

“View more” opens a separate Transactions page where the Admin can:

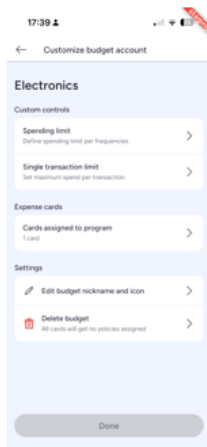
- Sort by: Date, Category, In/Out, Status (Cleared / Pending / Declined)
- Search via a search bar



Editing a Budget

From a specific budget (detail/settings), Admins can:

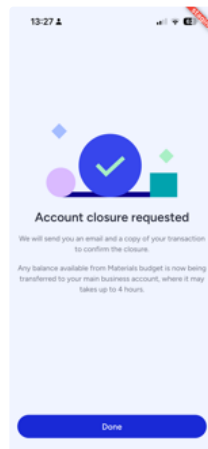
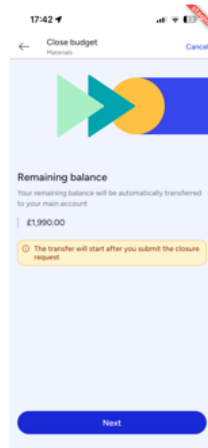
- Edit spending limits
- Edit single transaction limit
- View linked Expense Cards (virtual cards linked to this budget)
- Edit budget nickname and icon
- Delete budget



Deleting a Budget (closure behaviour)

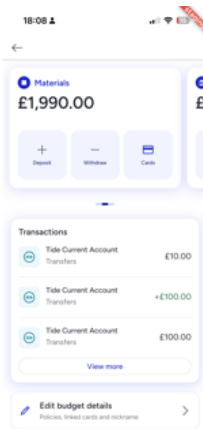
When an Admin deletes a budget:

- A pre-delete screen informs them of remaining balance and that it will be automatically transferred back to the main BCA.
- Upon closure request, any linked virtual cards are cancelled.
- After completion, the user receives a confirmation email.
- Any remaining money is automatically transferred to the main BCA.



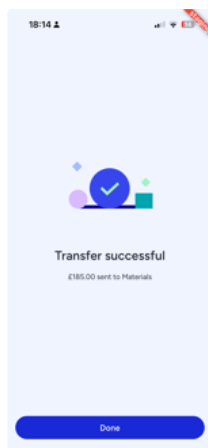
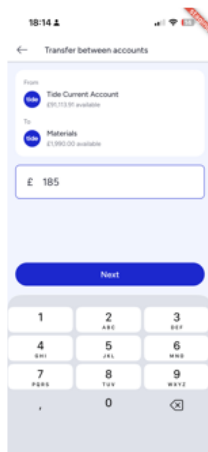
Adding / withdrawing money

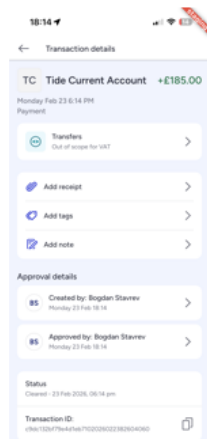
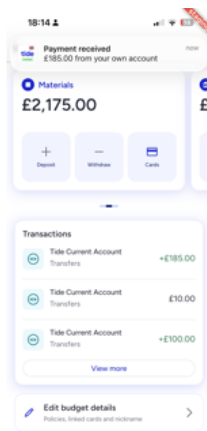
Only Admins can fund or withdraw budget money.



Deposit (top up a budget)

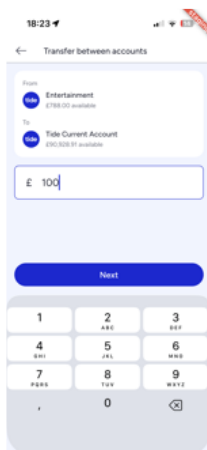
- Navigate to the budget
- Tap “+ Deposit”
- Funds move from the main BCA to the budget almost instantly

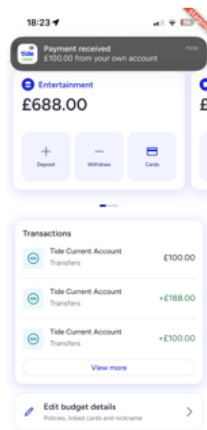
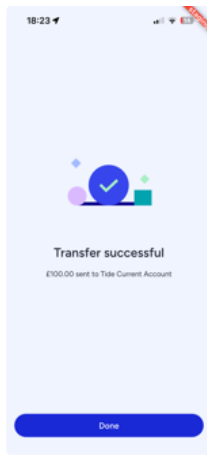




Withdraw

- Navigate to the budget
- Tap “- Withdraw”
- Funds move from the budget back to the main BCA almost instantly





Cards on Budgets (virtual prepaid)

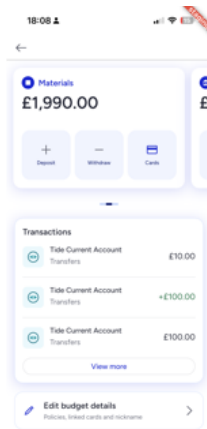
- Only virtual cards can be linked to budgets.
- These are Tide Prepaid cards.
- Usable for online shopping where prepaid is accepted.
- Usable for in-person payments by adding the card to mobile wallets.

Limits interaction: card vs budget

- Card-level limits exist and can be set by Admins (per Tide policy).
- Enforcement order: 1) card-level limits, then 2) budget-level limits.
- A card-level limit *cannot exceed* the budget limit.

Quick access to linked cards

Each Budget has a “Cards” icon that shows all linked virtual cards for that budget.



Risk / Ops considerations (what to know)

- External transfers in/out could be blocked or allowed for the Budgets account (decision to be made) - in case they are allowed, our recommendation is not to show the SortCode and AccountN. Latest hypothesis is to hide SortC+AccN and implement logic to allocate a possible incoming external bank transfer to the first available Budget Pot. In case we're mandated to show those details, then the recommendation is to implement blocking of incoming external transfers: budgets are for internal allocation and controlled spend, not for receiving/sending bank transfers directly.
- Budget funds always originate from and return to the main BCA; there is no automatic sweep.
- Team Members cannot see budget balances/spend, reducing information exposure while still enabling controlled payments via cards.
- Deleting a budget triggers: automatic return of remaining funds to main BCA + cancellation of linked cards + confirmation email (support should expect these user questions).

Glossary

- *BCA*: Business Current Account (main account).
- *Budget / Budget Pot*: A sub-account-like pot used to earmark money and optionally control spend via linked virtual cards.
- *Budgets account (ClearBank)*: The underlying account container used to hold nested sub-accounts (budgets); blocks external transfers.
- *Tide Prepaid virtual card*: Virtual card type used for budget-linked spend.